

# Custom Agent Guidance

Bounded roles, explicit tools, human review

# Preflight

---

Before a live exercise, verify current documentation and customer policy for:

- repository and data boundary;
- supported surface and profile syntax;
- permitted tools and MCP access;
- reviewer, meter, escalation, and stop guard.

Use a non-sensitive starter task. A manual profile review is the fallback.

# A role charter

---

```
.github/agents/  
└─ test-writer.md
```

A profile names one job, allowed inputs and tools, validation, stop conditions, and a manual fallback. It does not grant new authority.

# Least privilege

| Need                  | Capability             | Decision             |
|-----------------------|------------------------|----------------------|
| Read target and tests | Repository read/search | Allow if approved    |
| Add test              | Edit named test file   | Allow if approved    |
| Run known test        | Command execution      | Conditional          |
| External data         | MCP or network         | Remove unless needed |
| Merge                 | Privileged action      | Human only           |

## Demo task

---

```
Add tests for `validateEmail`.  
- `"ada@example.com"` returns `true`.  
- `"invalid"` returns `false`.  
- `` returns `false`.  
- Change tests only.  
- Run the verified focused test command.
```

Review the diff and test result separately. Stop if production code needs to change.

# Pick the smallest extension

| Need                         | Use          |
|------------------------------|--------------|
| Repository convention        | Instructions |
| Repeatable procedure         | Skill        |
| Specialized role             | Custom agent |
| Approved external capability | MCP          |

# Lab

Create and review a test-writer and documentation profile. Use the data-analyst exercise only after its MCP server is approved.